

general, keep the connectors as short as possible without having to twist them too much.

7. Cloth, tissue etc

If this will be the first time you're opening up the box, you'll need to do a lot of cleaning. Keep cloth and tissue handy to clean up the case, especially contact points.

8. A vacuum cleaner

No, not a 400 W home vac—just one of those small ones you get for laptop keyboards. This is useful to clean up places that are hard to reach with cloth and tissue.

9. An IC inserter and extractor

These will be needed if you're going to work on the CPU or do any kind of advanced tinkering with the motherboard. These should be available in some computer stores.

10. Finally, an adjustable wrench

This will come in handy for tough screws and nuts.